ERFWeb Administrator Guide

Nov 5, 2026 · @Jay Bryan

The System Administrator sets up accounts, roles, approvers, rates and rules, so every report routes to the right people at the right rates.

Before you start

Sign in as `admin` in Chrome or Edge. The left menu shows **Users**, **Master data** and **Rules** under Administration, **Scope** and **Rates** under Signatory structure, and **Audit**.

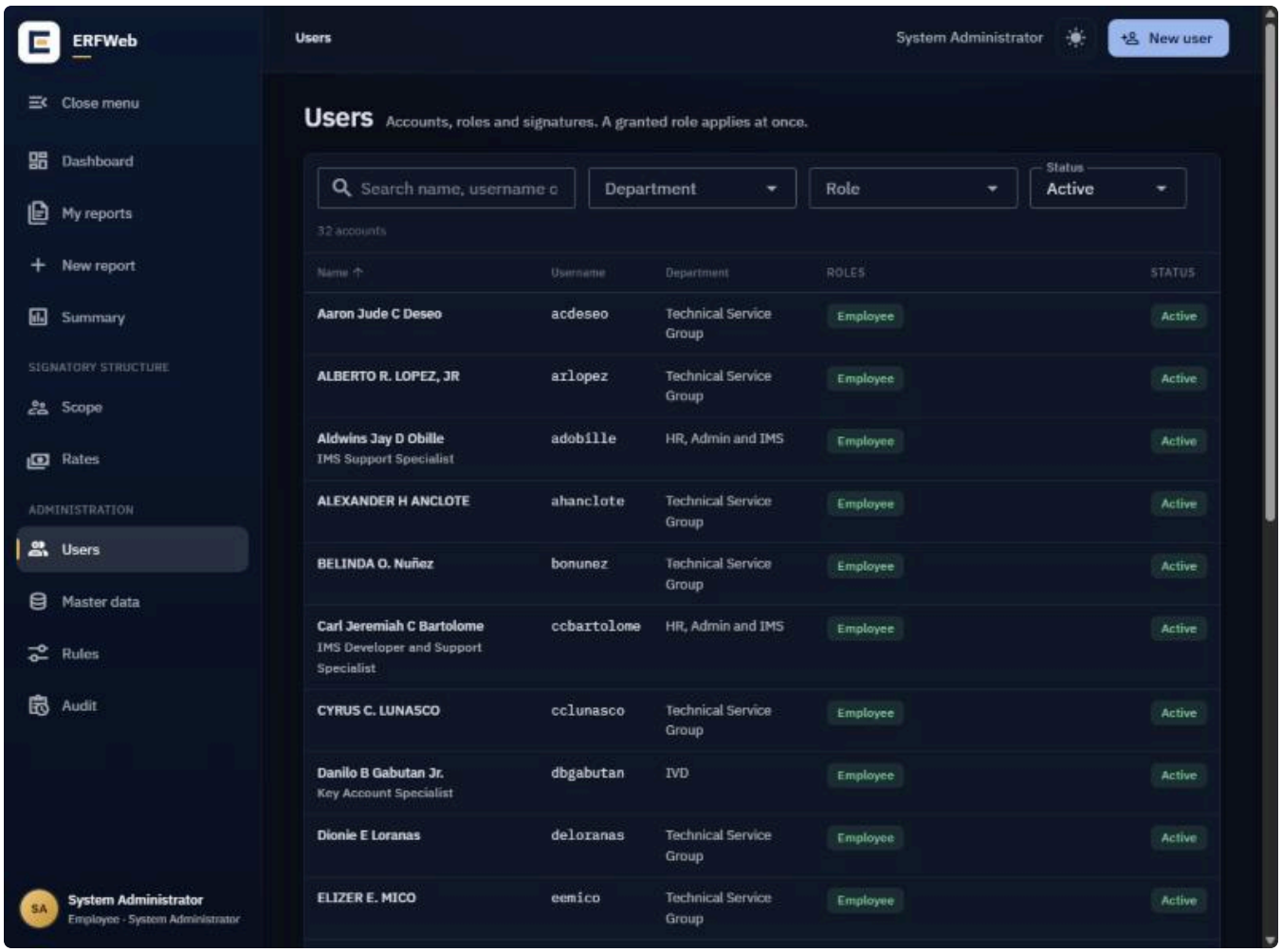
- You set up the system; you never see report contents and never file or approve.
- You cannot change your own account: no edits, role changes, resets or deactivation on it (it shows **This is you**).
- Every change you make is written to the audit trail, which Finance can read too.

Set things up in this order the first time: master data, then accounts and roles, then scope, then rates, then rules.

Set up a new person

Create the account

1. Click **Users**, then **New user**.
2. Under **Profile**, fill **Full name**, **Position**, **Department**, **Job grade**, **Email** (name plus **Domain**) and **Mobile no.** (needed for SMS).
3. Optional: under **CRM link**, search the CRM by name, initials or employee ID and pick the person. Empty **Full name** and **Mobile no.** fill from the CRM.
4. Turn on **Available as a “Work With” person on expense lines** if others list this person as a companion.
5. Under **Sign-in**, set **Username** and a **Temporary password** (at least 8 characters) twice. The person must choose their own password at first sign-in.
6. Save.



Grant roles

Everyone is an Employee. On the person's page, under **Roles**, click **Grant role**, pick the **Role**, add a **Note (optional)** and click **Grant**. It applies at once.

Role	Gives
Signatory Level 1 / Level 2	Approvals, Delegations, Budgets; needs a scope (next section)
Finance	Finance queue, Signatures, Budgets, Audit
Expense Verifier	Verifications

A System Administrator holds no other role; Finance cannot also be a signatory or a verifier. **Revoke** removes a role.

Load the signature

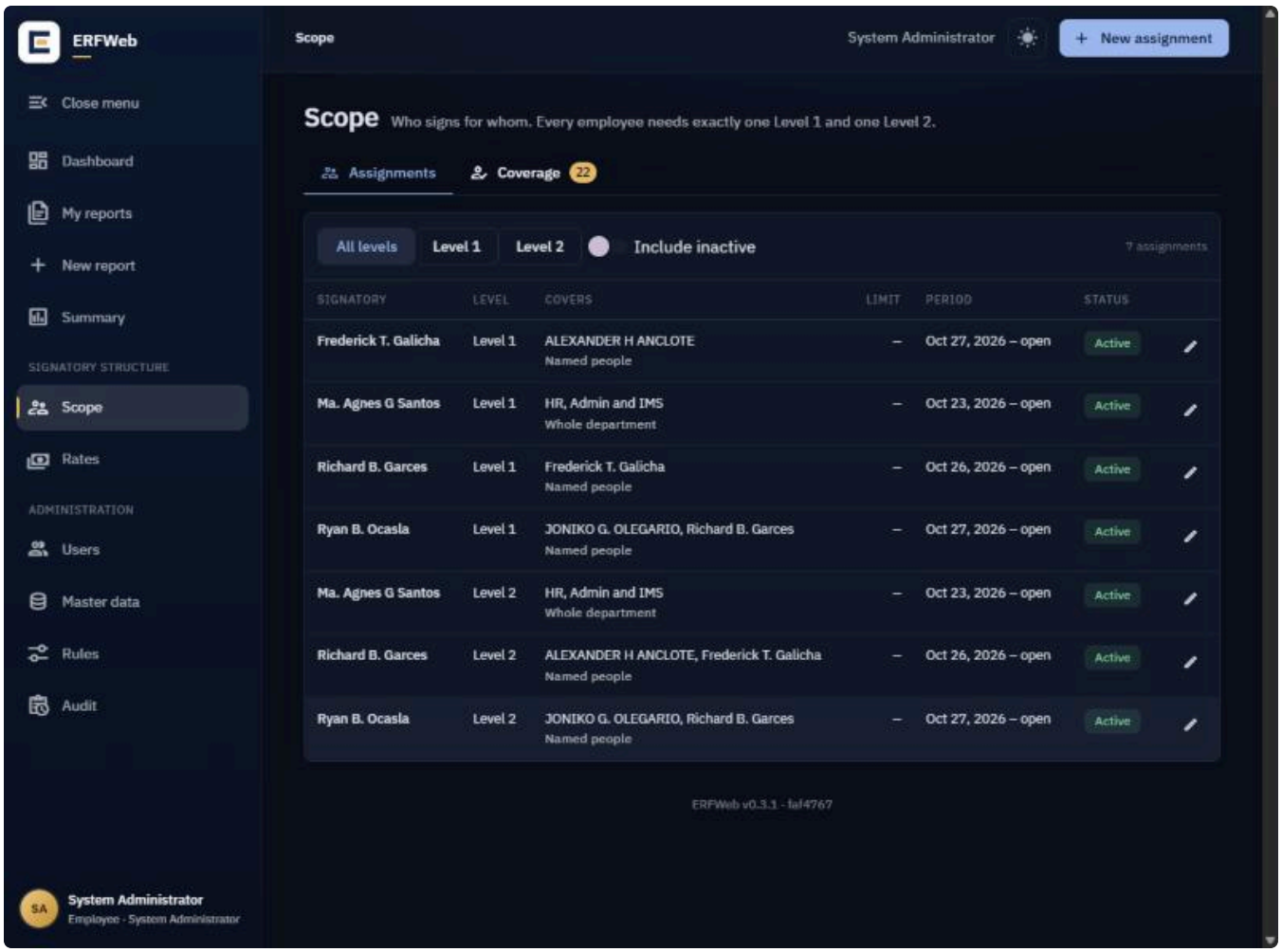
Under **Signature**, click **Upload signature** (**Replace signature** when one is on file), choose a PNG or JPEG and click **Save signature**. The card shows **Waiting for Finance** until Finance approves the image on their **Signatures** page, then **Approved**. Only an approved signature prints on the R47, with an ELECTRONIC SIGNATURE watermark: for the employee, and for signatories once they approve. A signature is optional: without one the person can still file and signs the printed R47 instead.

Remove signature deletes it after you confirm with **Remove**. Every R47 that person prepared or approved, past ones included, then prints their name without a signature until a new one is loaded and approved.

Scope: who approves for whom

A scope assignment names the signatory for a department or for named people, at Level 1 or Level 2. Each employee needs exactly one Level 1, and one Level 2 when Level 2 is required.

1. Click **Scope**, then **New assignment**.
2. Pick the **Signatory** (they must hold that level's role) and the **Level**.
3. Under **Covers**, choose a whole department, named people, or a department except named people. A named person beats the department rule.
4. Optional: an **Approval limit** (blank for no limit) and **Effective from** / **Effective to** (blank for open-ended).
5. Save. A save that would give anyone two signatories at one level is refused.



Click a row to edit any field, including the signatory and level. Reports already filed keep the signatories they were routed to.

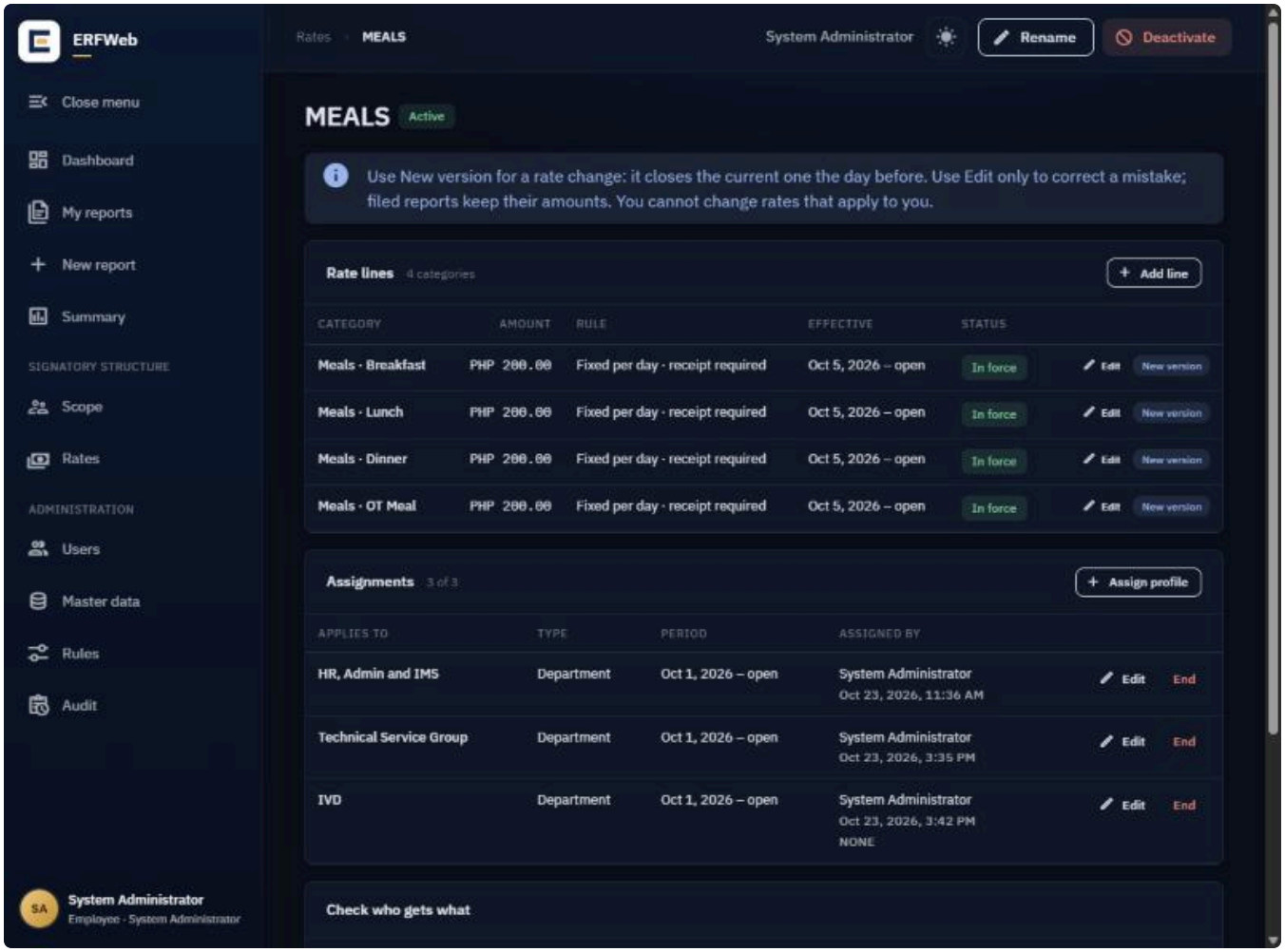
Check coverage. The **Coverage** tab lists every active employee with their Level 1 and Level 2. Turn on **Only problems** to see who has none or too many; fix those before go-live, because they cannot file.

Rates

A rate profile holds the allowed amounts per category (meals per meal: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, OT Meal). A report always uses the rate in force on the expense date.

1. Click **Rates**, then **New profile**; give it a **Name** and click **Create**.
2. Under **Rate lines**, click **Add line**: pick the **Category** (and **Meal**), the **Amount**, **Rate type**, **Requires receipt**, an optional **Frequency cap**, and **Effective from**.

3. Under **Assignments**, click Assign profile and choose a person, a job grade, a department or the whole company, with **Effective from**. A person's own assignment beats their grade, which beats their department, which beats the company.
4. Use **Check who gets what** to see the rates a person gets on a date.



Changing a rate. Click New version on the line (it closes the old one the day before), or **Edit** to correct a version in place with a reason. A change dated before today needs **Backdate override** and a reason. Filed reports keep their amounts.

You cannot assign a profile to yourself by name.

Master data

Master data has a tab per list. Entries are deactivated, never deleted.

Tab	What to keep up to date
Departments	Names, and the department's **Reviewed by (R47)** initials (blank uses the Rules default)
Cost centers	One per department, with this year's budget; **Earlier budgets** shows past years read-only. Budgets are for monitoring only
Currencies	The **Default currency for new reports**
Fare modes	Taxi, Grab, Angkas… with **Sort order**; Others lets the employee type the mode
Sites	Locations used on reports
Expense categories	Read-only: fixed by the R47 layout

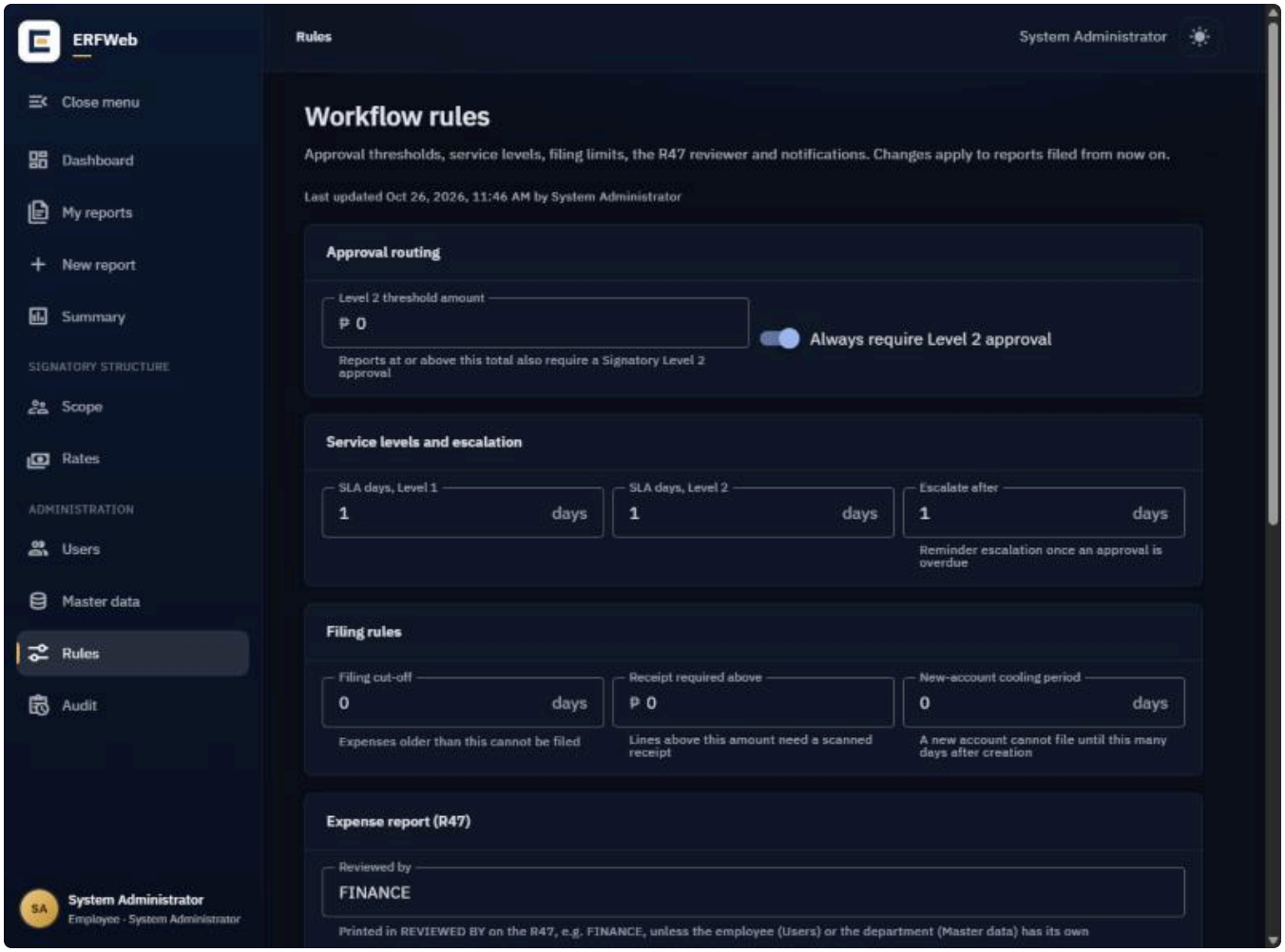
Set a new budget on each cost center at the start of every year.

Rules

Rules holds the workflow settings. Change what you need and click **Save rules** (or **Discard changes**).

Section	Settings
Approval routing	**Always require Level 2 approval**, **Level 2 threshold amount**
Service levels and escalation	**SLA days, Level 1**, **SLA days, Level 2**, **Escalate after**
Filing rules	**Filing cut-off** (how old an expense may be), **Receipt required above**, **New-account cooling period**
Expense report (R47)	**Reviewed by** (default initials), **Signatures on the R47**, **Format of the R47** and **Open the R47 designer** (see below)
Notifications	**Email** and **SMS** switches, **Notification from address**

Section	Settings
Account email domains	The domains offered on the user form; the first is the default



Signatures on the R47

Under **Expense report (R47)**, pick how signatures print:

- **E-signature** (default): signatures Finance approved print with an ELECTRONIC SIGNATURE watermark and "Electronically signed in ERFWeb" with the date, time and ERF reference.
- **Status only**: no signature images; each place prints "Electronically approved" (or "Electronically filed" for the employee) with the date and time.

Format of the R47

1. Under **Format of the R47**, pick the **PDF engine**: **QuestPDF** (the original R47 renderer) or **PDFsharp** (the same form drawn with PDFsharp). Both print the same form and page breaks.
2. Edit the header details: **Company name**, **Company short name** (also printed on the BAL DUE TO line), **Form title**, **Document code**, **Effectivity date** (printed as typed, e.g. May 15, 2023) and **Revision no.** Each has a character limit so it fits its box.
3. Click **Save rules**. The next R47 printed or emailed uses the change; nothing needs restarting.

R47 designer

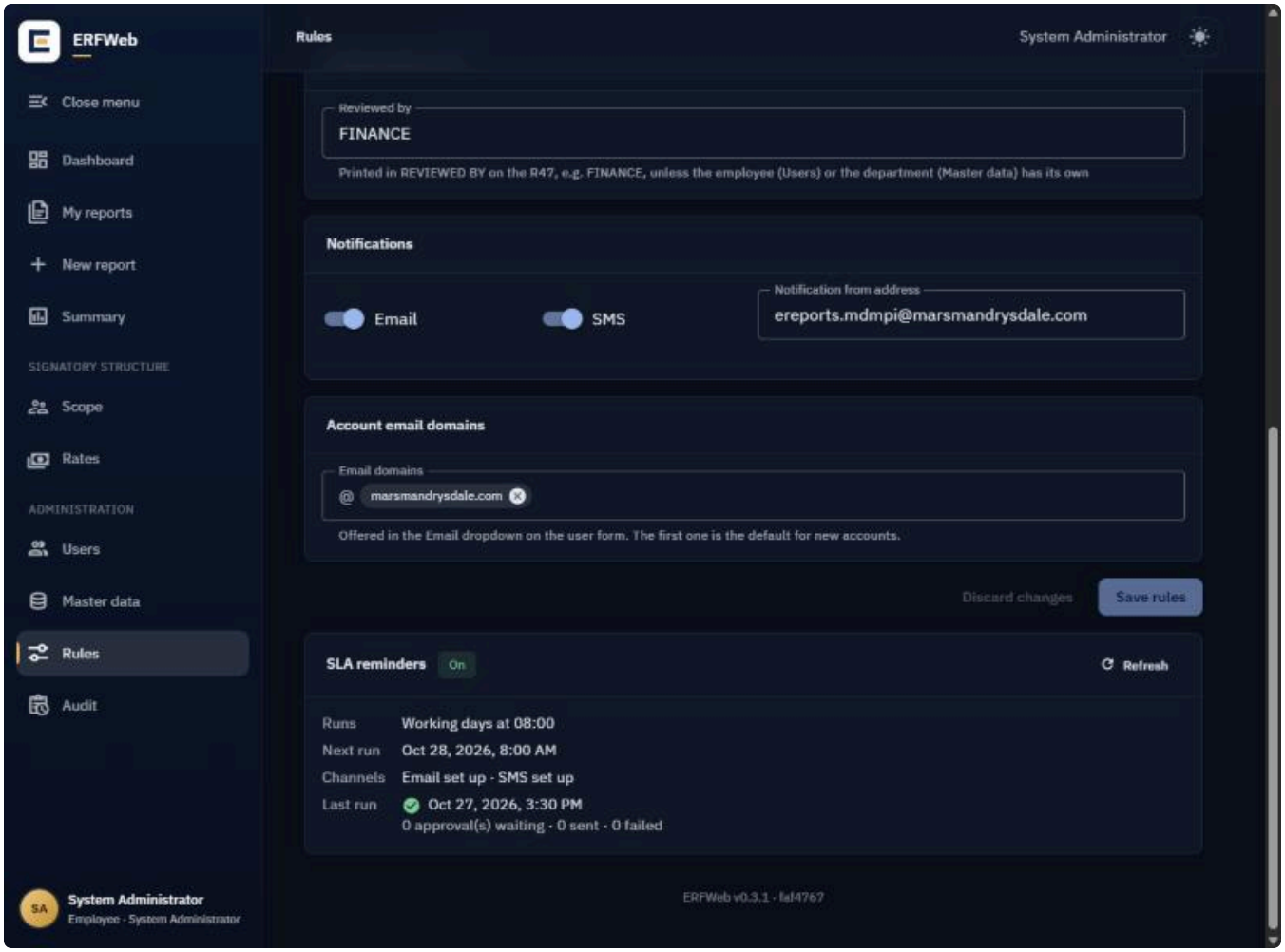
Click **Open the R47 designer** to change the layout of the form: margins, band heights, column widths, type sizes, colours and fixed texts. The order and content of the bands stay the controlled form.

1. In the drawing, drag a band edge or column divider, or select one with Tab and move it with the arrow keys (Shift moves 5 pt). Click a band to open its values.
2. For exact values, open a section on the right: **Page margins**, **Header**, **DATE stamp and employee**, **Grid** (the 13 column widths, which must fill the width between the margins), **Totals rows** (**Revolving fund line**), **Cash advance and reconciliation** (**Note after BAL DUE TO**), **Footer** (the promise, up to 6 lines of 70 characters, and **Promise alignment Left** or **Center**) and **Type and colours** (two colours; the grid stays in Tahoma).
3. Under **Preview**, pick **Sample report** (made-up data, two pages) or **A report** (search by employee name, purpose or ER reference; drafts included), pick **Rules page engine**, **QuestPDF** or **PDFsharp**, and click **Preview PDF**. A preview saves and sends nothing.
4. Click **Save layout** and confirm with **Save layout**. Every R47 printed or emailed from then on uses it; R47s already printed keep their old copies.

Undo (or Ctrl+Z) steps back, **Discard changes** returns to the saved layout, and **Reset to standard** returns to the standard form. The chip at the top reads **Saved layout** or **Standard form**, plus **Unsaved changes** while you edit. When a value does not fit, a list under **Fix these before saving or previewing** says what to change.

SLA reminders

SLA reminders card. It shows whether the server sends reminders (`Reminders:Enabled`), the run time and **Next run**, which **Channels** (email, SMS) are set up, and the **Last run** with its result. *No run recorded yet* means it has not run since the last deployment. The on/off switch and run time are in the server's settings file, not on this page.



Everyday tasks

- **Forgotten password or locked out.** Open the person in **Users**, click **Reset password**, enter a **New password** twice and click **Set password**. This also unlocks the account; they choose their own password at next sign-in. (Five wrong passwords lock an account for 15 minutes.)
- **Someone leaves.** Click **Deactivate** on their page. They can no longer sign in; their reports and history stay. End their scope assignments too.

- **Change details.** Click **Edit** on their page. Changing department or grade can change their rates and approvers from that day.
- **Read the audit trail. Audit** lists every administration and workflow change with who, when and what; filter by event, person and dates. It cannot be edited.

Test system only: Delete buttons. When ERFWeb runs in test mode, a red **TEST** chip shows at the top and a red Delete (bin) button appears on records such as users, master data, rate profiles, scope assignments, delegations, budgets, reports and audit entries. It asks **Delete test data?** and deletes permanently. The live system does not run in test mode, so these buttons never appear there.

Common problems

What an employee or you sees	What to do
Checklist says no approver found, or two	Fix their scope; check **Scope → Coverage → Only problems**
A signature does not print on the R47	On their user page the Signature card must show **Approved**; if it shows **Waiting for Finance**, ask Finance to approve it on **Signatures**. With **Status only** under Rules, no images print
Meal amount stays ₱0	No rate profile reaches them on that date; check **Check who gets what**
New employee cannot file yet	The cooling period has not passed; lower it under **Rules** if needed
No texts or emails arrive	Check their mobile number and email, and the **Notifications** switches
Role grant refused	The combination is not allowed (for example Finance plus signatory)
CRM search says unavailable	The CRM is down or not configured; save without the link and add it later